

be imagined as basically being able to illuminate the subject straight head on, while an off camera flash will tend to provide an off angle lighting for photography. Practically you will see that off camera flashes will make the subject look more three dimensional rather than flat. This happens because with an on camera flash, the side of the subject that receives the maximum direct light is also the side being captured thus leaving little room for shadows to be visible while rendering a harshly lit subject, giving it like a hapless deer in the headlight sort of look. You most definitely would have noticed the photographer's assistant lunging around a hot camera flash in weddings and other indoor events but this is not always feasible. Thus a simple trick is commonly used to achieve this effect- bounce you on camera flash off an object like a wall or ceiling or use a flash bracket that will increase the distance between the front of your camera and the flash unit. This may not give the right effect for long range shots but the closer your subject is, the more substantial will be the off angle lighting effect. As you can imagine, flash brackets tend to be quite large since they need to extend far above or to the side of the camera body in order to achieve their role.

Another common term you may have come across in dealing with flashes is 'fill flash'. Fill flash or fill-in flash are today present in most DSLRs and point and shoot cameras too. It is basically a simple photographic technique used to brighten deep shadow areas, indicative of the fact that the photographer has used a flash to 'fill in' shadowy areas in the composition and plays the role of a secondary flash too.

In outdoor setups fill flashes can be used to highlight faces or any other parts of the picture you don't want drowned in the shadows. Indoors it allows you to see certain parts of your shot more brightly lit and make them more dramatic, like making the subjects' eyes seem more alive. Having said that, it is still a common misconception



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that a flash is used only in situations where it's dark. Contrary to this, fill flashes are most useful under bright ambient lighting, like back lit subjects, or when the lighting presents too much contrast. Most cameras do not fire the flash unless the scene is rather dimly lit, in which case you will need to forcefully use it. And in such situations when enough ambient light is present on using your SLR's flash it automatically acts like a fill flash.